

Corporate Communication Policy & Guidelines

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Purpose

The policy is to establish guidelines for all External (Corporate, Social, Branded, and individual driven) Communication for Poonawalla Fincorp Limited (PFL), including and not limited to the release of information about the company to the public at large, media, customers, investors, shareholders, regulatory authorities, and all other relevant stakeholders

Scope

The policy is applicable to all employees (on-roll and off-roll) of PFL and mandates that those covered do not disclose internal matters and developments which relate in any way to material, non-public information to any person non-affiliated with the company.

The policy governs all disclosures in news, earning releases, senior management speeches, presentations, press releases (print, electronic, digital), information on the company website, intranet, and discussions in public and quasi-public areas where the conversation may be reported. All those governed by the policy should not participate in, host, or link to public and industry discussion forums, internet chat boards, social media platforms, blogs and/or other similar media to discuss the company or company's products, services, technology, processes, or innovations, in any fashion, unless authorized through this policy or with the exception of linking as required owing to the role of the employee.

Objective

Communication plays a critical role within PFL. As a listed company, PFL must comply with relevant legislation, regulations and standards concerning securities markets and financial reporting.

The company has the obligation to ensure that specific information related to the business and affairs of the company is disclosed on a timely, consistent, and appropriate manner i.e.,

1. To meet the information requirements of media, public at large, and other stakeholders
2. To build up trust in the corporate brand and ensure that PFL's brand image commensurate with the company's performance and achievements
3. To prevent the possibility of wrong/negative publicity of PFL

The Policy provides guidelines for how communication should be conducted to ensure that it is in accordance with the company's interests. In today's world, requirements and standards are constantly changing, and accordingly, the Communication Policy will be scrutinized, reviewed, and revised on an ongoing basis.

Definitions

Company stands for Poonawalla Fincorp Limited

Employee stands for all PFL employees – any person employed by the company, including the senior management team

SMT stands for the senior management team

Corporate Communication Team stands for Head Brand, PR and Communications and Senior Manager PR

PR stands for Public Relations

Media stands for news media like TV Channels, print publications, online portals, social media sites, financial analysts, research analysts, and industry researcher bodies

Spokesperson Matrix

The Managing Director (MD) is the Chief Spokesperson of the Company. The following SMT members are the other authorized spokespersons, and shall be responsible for interactions in the following areas –

S.No.	Designation	Mandate
1	Chairman of the Board	All strategic and corporate updates, as deemed appropriate
2	MD	All Corporate, strategic, results, expansion, regulatory, policy, new businesses, tech, innovations, products, brand, commentary on the economic updates etc.

Spokesperson's governing role

Apart from the authorized spokespersons as listed above, no other SMT member or employee is permitted to make statements or discuss company matters with media on behalf of the company, unless otherwise recommended by Corporate Communication team and approved by the MD.

All those governed by the policy are hereby requested to not respond, under any circumstances, to enquires from media or any other external source, and should immediately divert all such queries/requests/enquiries to the Corporate Communication team

Exceptions:

1. Company secretary and Chief Compliance Officer can respond to queries and clarifications raised by SEBI, stock exchanges, registered shareholders, and regulatory bodies like RBI
2. Chief Compliance Officer can respond to queries related to legal and tax issues from various legal authorities and tax bodies

3. Depending upon the issues/ events the MD may authorize any of the SMT members or Corporate Communication head to represent the company.

Investor Relations

The company's Investor Relations (IR) function is guided by a dedicated team primarily comprising the Chairman, MD, CFO and Head Investor Relations.

1. The team shall interact with Analysts, institutional investors, rating agencies and other investors with an objective to impart a better understanding of company and its strategies and thereby help getting a fair market valuation for company's securities and a favorable market opinion.
2. The team shall provide guidance on emerging macroeconomic parameters, non-banking, and regulatory outlook through quarterly presentations.
3. The teams shall also update on any major changes like the composition of the company's top management or Board of Directors to Investors, Analysts and Media.
4. The company shall conduct Analysts Meet every quarter after the announcement of its quarterly financial results. Besides making a comprehensive presentation, the company's spokesperson shall interact with analysts and address their queries and concerns upfront. During such interaction, the company's management may also provide guidance on the company's future performance in a conservative fashion by appropriately factoring -in risks emanating from macroeconomic environment.
5. The company shall also endeavor to upload the relevant information on the website as and when appropriate of such Analysts Meetings covering presentations and interactions.

Silent Period

At the end of each quarter, the Company shall observe a "silent period" with respect to all communication with the media and investor community, commencing at the close of the quarter.

During this silent period –

1. The Company, including any designated spokesperson of the Company, will refrain from providing any information or guidance on matters potentially impacting earnings outlooks
2. Communication shall be restricted to past performance, product promotions, new launches (only product proposition to be specified, NO forecast on potential business or forward-looking figures can be shared)
3. No press conferences or meetings will be conducted during the silent period
4. 48 hrs. prior to the expected earnings release, the Company will cease all communication with external stakeholders.

The quiet period ends 48 hours after the earnings are publicly released.

All communications during this period needs to be approved by Corporate Communication, Compliance and MD office.

Price sensitive information

PFL is listed on BSE and NSE and thus is subject to laws and regulations that govern any price-sensitive information. Details of any price sensitive information is available in the Code of Conduct Policy of PFL. Use and dissemination of any such price sensitive information is strictly forbidden. All other information (non-price sensitive) should also be routed through corporate communications team for further dissemination.

Brand Guidelines

To ensure consistency in communication of brand, PFL has set brand guidelines, which clearly covers the various aspects of PFL's identity like logo, corporate stationery, etc. All forms of communication should be in strict adherence with the brand guidelines and any deviation must be with prior explicit approval of the MD.

Role of Corporate Communications Team

1. Corporate communication team is responsible for initiating, coordinating, managing, responding to all media interactions
2. Corporate communication team will receive and route all media queries, requests, and opportunities to the authorized spokesperson. All employees need to route all such request, if received by them, to the Corporate Communications team
3. Corporate Communications team may coordinate with other vertical heads to prepare Media release for product launch, new initiatives, etc. based on published facts, with restrictions on any type of futuristic issues / views on Corporate Policy, Financial Results, Management structure / Change, Future plans of the company, Government Policy or any other information that is not in public domain.
4. Media release to be disseminated only by Corporate Communications team. No other employee is allowed to talk to media unless he/ she is authorized media spokesperson.
5. Corporate communication team is the interface between external stakeholders and PFL and can share any information which is already available on public domain in any form as well as information authorized by official spokesperson.
6. Corporate communication team is responsible to ensure effective flow of information of the company to employees, stakeholders, public at large, and customers, with prior approval of MD through various media platforms.

Approval Matrix for External Communications

1. Press Release/Media Information Dissemination – the following steps are to be taken for the review and approval of all PFL's financial and marketing press releases –
 - The release should be drafted using standard template as per brand guidelines
 - Initial review and approval to be with internal corporate resources (business and vertical heads)

- If the press release mentions a partner or is a joint release, preliminary internal review shall occur prior to external approval
 - Once press release is reviewed and approved by internal and external parties, the same needs be reviewed by the legal and compliance team
 - Final sign off will be by the MD to corporate communication team who will further disseminate it to the target media
2. Participation in events, forums, awards, webinars, seminars, academic discussions, etc.
- Participation in any industry, media, research, academic event or forum or award is subject to recommendation by corporate communication team and approved by MD. Any employee receiving any invite from any external body should route the same to the corporate communication team and the team will further coordinate internally for requisite approval
 - The above conditions apply for all formats – digital as well as offline events, as well as for non-commercial/branded participations like guest lectures etc.
 - No employee can invite any media to internal or partner events without prior approval from the corporate communication team. Addressing media in such events will also be strictly governed by the policy and subject to MD approval.
 - No printed, digital, or verbal material containing company information can be shared, displayed, or disseminated in any media or industry event or forums without prior approval from the corporate communication team

Guidelines to talk to media

A journalist or any media representative may contact any employee for a number of reasons. Please refer to the following guidelines for such scenarios –

1. Please refer all such call, emails, or other form of communication to the corporate communication team
2. Please do not say you are not allowed to talk to a reporter or will have to take permission to do so. Instead, politely refer them to corporate communication team as the right point of contact
3. Please extend the same courtesy and professionalism to media in which you approach the customers
4. Please act quickly when approached by media to ensure that the reporter's deadline is met. It is important because the way the call is handled may be the first impression of the company for the reporter
5. Please ensure that you contact the corporate communication team immediately after you have been contacted by media with all relevant information, even if you have already directed media to do so.
6. Company spokespersons shall endeavor to use an approved script for all public presentations designed or intended to disclose material information about the company's financial performance, results of operations and the company's current or expected financial results.
7. For media interactions spokesperson must be dressed in formal attire.

Guidelines on photographs and films

A similar process as described above will be used when someone from media is requesting permission to take photographs or film inside our offices (HO as well as branches). No one should be given access to any facility belonging to the company for photography without prior approval from the admin and the corporate communication team

Guidelines for Social Media

1. No employee is authorized to share any update, news, event, photographs, media, and, or statement on behalf of PFL in his or her personal capacity in any manner whatsoever on social media. However, they are not barred from personal use of such platforms.
2. In case of any queries or discussions related to PFL on social media platforms, the employee should immediately report the same to the corporate communication team and not engage with any such conversation in personal capacity in any manner whatsoever.

Exception: Employees can however share professional updates, personal views, and non-sensitive information on LinkedIn. However, the employee must clearly specify that the statement is from a personal viewpoint and does not necessarily reflect the views or the opinions of PFL or its management.

Violation of Policy

Any violation of the Corporate Communication policy will result in strict disciplinary action as per the Code of Conduct policy guidelines

All employees (on roll and off role) are mandatorily bound by this policy, and it is their duty to bring to the corporate communication team's notice should they come across any violation of any form across any forum. The final decision on the violation act remains with the Head Corporate Communications and MD.

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